

August 28, 2026

John Simmons, TERO Director
and Members of the TERO Commission
Kiowa Tribe of Oklahoma
P.O. Box 369
Carnegie, OK 73015

Re: Request for release of the Kiowa Tribe TERO certified vendor list for academic research

Dear Director Simmons and Members of the Commission:

My name is Elijah S. Moreno. I am an enrolled member of the Coastal Band of the Chumash Nation and a PhD candidate in public policy at Cornell University. My research documents individually owned Native businesses, which today are not systematically counted anywhere. At the Center for Indian Country Development I created the Native Entity Enterprise Dataset (NEED), and I have contributed to the Harvard Project on American Indian Economic Development. Official tribal certification lists are the most authoritative evidence in this work: nothing overrides what a nation says about its own certified businesses.

Request. I respectfully request a copy of the current Kiowa Tribe TERO certified vendor list, in whatever format is easiest for the office, and, if the Commission is willing, refreshed copies periodically on whatever cadence suits the office. The list would join records from tribal nations across the country in a research dataset documenting the scale, industries, and geographic breadth of individually owned Native businesses, and how tribal and federal policy investments, such as Indian preference in contracting, support individual entrepreneurship and shape reservation economies.

Intended use. Findings would appear in academic research and accessible published work, such as an article on how many tribes maintain certified vendor lists and the industries those businesses work in. I am also building a public online directory that collates individually owned Native enterprises across nations, so that these businesses are easier to find and engage. Kiowa listings would appear in that directory only if the Commission permits it. The Commission decides how Kiowa listings are used, and I commit to the following:

1. **Attribution.** Any published or directory use of a Kiowa listing will be credited to Kiowa Tribe TERO.
2. **Use at the Commission's direction.** The Commission chooses the level of use: verification and aggregate statistics only; inclusion in published research; and/or inclusion in the public directory. I will honor whichever combination the Commission approves.
3. **No redistribution.** The raw list file will not be posted, shared with third parties, sold, or redistributed. It will be stored securely and used only for this work.
4. **Correction and withdrawal.** The Commission may correct the data or withdraw permission at any time, including removal of any business, or all Kiowa listings, from the directory and from future work.
5. **Courtesy review.** The TERO office will receive a copy of any publication citing the list before it appears.

If the Commission prefers to formalize these terms in a data-sharing or data-use agreement, I will gladly sign one in whatever form the Commission chooses, and I welcome its guidance on what an appropriate process looks like. If the Commission declines, I fully respect that decision. Thank you for your consideration and for the work the TERO office does on behalf of Kiowa businesses and workers.

Respectfully,

Cornell University

Jeb E. Brooks School of Public Policy

Elijah S. Moreno
PhD Candidate, Public Policy
esm247@cornell.edu

Elijah S. Moreno

PhD Candidate, Jeb E. Brooks School of Public Policy, Cornell University

Enrolled member, Coastal Band of the Chumash Nation

esm247@cornell.edu